

Chapter 175-2

After a long while, Shen Hui turned around.

Zhao Xuning reached for her hand but only caught the hem of her clothes.

Shen Hui said: "I'll do the rest."

As her words fell, her knees bent and she knelt on the stone steps.

The cold of the stone steps seeped through her knees. Shen Hui placed her hands on the stone steps, her waist gradually bending, her forehead touching the stone steps with a muffled sound.

"Second Sister." Shen Siyan walked over wanting to help her up, but heard Shen Hui say: "Don't stop me."

Shen Siyan was momentarily speechless.

Liang Shi had originally been supporting the weakened Zhao Xuning at the side.

Although she exercised regularly and was in good shape, having come all the way up from the foot of the mountain with one bow at each step, every movement perfectly standard, her legs were now trembling, feeling as if they no longer belonged to her.

How could she possibly last through these nine hundred and ninety-nine remaining stone steps?

But Zhao Xuning shook her head at her, continuing to kneel, bow, and stand up again.

Shen Hui and Zhao Xuning were only a few stone steps apart. They were both devoutly walking upward, walking forward.

With each step passed, they were forgetting.

They were atoning.

They were being reborn.

Liang Shi and Shen Siyan could only watch from behind.

It went on until nearly dawn, when cold wind rose in the mountains.

Zhao Xuning's movements grew slower and slower. It took a long time for her to kneel, then stand up again.

Her pants had already worn through.

Even Liang Shi, who had only walked up, felt tired. She simply couldn't imagine how Zhao Xuning had managed it.

And Shen Hui had truly knelt through over nine hundred steps as well.

When they were nearly at the top, they saw Shen Fenghe and Gu Yixue standing at the summit.

Shen Siyan had long been heartbroken and aggrieved. He called out softly: "Big Sister."

His voice sounded soft and childish, but he was trying hard to control this behavior and his voice, so it came out sounding awkward.

Shen Fenghe lowered her gaze to look at Shen Hui, who was still kneeling and bowing with each step. In the end, she said nothing.

Shen Hui reached the top first. When she truly stood up, her legs went weak and she nearly fell, but Shen Siyan caught her.

Zhao Xuning was obviously much slower, her entire being looking pale and haggard, as if she could faint at any moment.

Liang Shi stood right next to the railing, very close to her, afraid she wouldn't hold on and would fall.

But her willpower was truly formidable, holding on until nearly the end.

Just as she was about to take the last step, her head tilted to the side and her whole body crumpled to the ground.

The nighttime rain came without warning. After a muffled thunder, the rain began to patter down, soaking Zhao Xuning completely.

It also drenched everyone standing there.

Mother Zhao had arrived long ago and had been waiting here.

The moment she saw Zhao Xuning, she went to help her up, but Zhao Xuning pushed her away. "Leave me alone."

Mother Zhao was too heartbroken to speak.

At this moment, Zhao Xuning was curled up in the rain, like a homeless stray dog.

Liang Shi wanted to go help her, but Zhao Xuning raised her hand that hung by her side slightly, her fingers curling, signaling her not to.

Then she slowly got up in the rain, stood again, took one step forward on her two weak legs, and slowly knelt down.

She completed the final bow.

The rain grew heavier and heavier.

But Zhao Xuning had lost all sensation. Even as she lost consciousness at the end, she was smiling.

Because she had fulfilled her promise to Shen Hui.

This time, she hadn't let Shen Hui down.

Many people were calling out to her.

But she couldn't hear any of them anymore.

Zhao Xuning thought, it was right to have sworn never to climb the three thousand steps.

Because after climbing the three thousand steps, one was not far from death. Even her soul felt like it was floating.

"Zhao Xuning!"

"Ningning!"

"Dr. Zhao!"

"....."

So many voices mixed together, but Zhao Xuning still picked out Shen Hui's.

Mixed among all those voices, she was anxiously calling her name: "Zhao Xuning."